★ MURDER AT THE DEADWOOD CANTINA ★

Deadwood Townsfolk

Dancer, Card player, Patron or Traveler — one of the colorful crowd at the tournament party.

How to Play It

Mingle, gossip and stir the pot! Pick a Western name, ask everybody nosy questions, and pass along any juicy rumors you hear. Dancers: sell those dance tickets and sarsaparillas!

For any extra role: pick 3 to use

1. Mitch Maverick! Congratulations on the big win — a businessman beat the poker greats? How'd you do it?
2. Harry, should we be worried about this cantina closin' its doors?
3. Sheriff Sam, got any leads on who robbed the bank earlier this week?
4. Henrietta, that's a mighty fancy necklace. Where'd you get it?
5. Billie, just how bad are the cantina's finances, and who do you blame?
6. Jesse Wales, what brings you to town — and what happened to that hand?

Be Ready If Asked

"Why are you in town?" → Make up a story: passing through to the gold fields, here for the tournament, visiting kin...

"Did you see anything this week?" → "Didn't see the robbery myself, but I've heard plenty of talk. What have YOU heard?"

"Who do you suspect?" → "I've got my eye on a few folks. Buy me a sarsaparilla and I'll tell ya." (Share gossip; don't invent evidence.)

When to use these: After Harry's welcome, pick 3 lines, go find the person each one mentions (or anyone nearby) and work all three into conversation before the lights go out. Tell the host quietly when you're done. After the murder, follow your B envelope.

Conversation starters for the opening of the party • your character sheet always comes first

OBJECTIVES

Starting Objectives:

- Question Gambling Jack (a card player) on his friendship with Harry High-Stakes (the cantina owner).
- Find out from Jesse Wales (an outlaw) why he/she is in town this week. Ask Jesse about their wounded hand.
- Ask both Poker Alice (the poker dealer) and Barb Cassidy (an outlaw) about their intentions toward Billie-The-Bartender (the barmaid).
- Find out from Billie-The-Bartender how far she would go to win the loyalty of Poker Alice.
- Comment to Anna Belle (Gambling Jack's backer) on Jack's loss. See who Anna Belle blames and follow any leads she gives you.



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Cantina Patron C

As a resident of Deadwood, you are a frequent visitor and a patron of the cantina. Since the town itself is still in its settlement phase, businesses and residents are just beginning to make Deadwood their home. When The Deadwood Cantina was established a little over a year ago, you welcomed the business with open arms. In the past year, you have seen the popularity of the cantina go from good to great. The Deadwood Cantina has become one of the prime locations to socialize and do business in town. As a resident, you visit the cantina nightly as do many of the other locals, including Clay Coldwell (a local card player). While at the cantina, you witness a great deal including an interesting rivalry between Barb Cassidy (an outlaw), Billie-The-Bartender (the barmaid) and Poker Alice (the poker dealer). From an outsider's point of view, it appears that Barb Cassidy cares a great deal for Billie-The-Bartender who cares a great deal for Poker Alice. Since Alice has a very uppity exterior, you are uncertain of her feelings for Billie.

Since the town of Deadwood is still a budding frontier town, at times one might find it boring as you have. With the Deadwood Poker Tournament in town, however, there has been an air of liveliness that is very refreshing with new faces and continuous action in the cantina.

Being a resident of Deadwood, you have noticed a great number of foreign faces in the city including Jesse Wales (an outlaw). Knowing that Jesse and Harry High-Stakes (the cantina owner) are old friends put your mind at ease. However, after the recent bank robbery in town, you are not certain if Jesse is here to visit acquaintances or for business matters. As luck would have it, another old companion of Harry's visiting this week is Gambling Jack (a card player). Being that Harry is known for his high-stakes card playing, it is no surprise to you that Jack and Harry are friends. Ironically, the one person who did seem surprised at the acquaintance of the two men was Anna Belle (Gambling Jack's backer). Following the tournament, you have heard some complaints that Harry favored Gambling Jack in the tournament, but you do not believe those rumors to be true since Jack (like the other card players) had to pay the same ante fee to get into the tournament. To top it off, Gambling Jack did not win the tournament, which would further indicate that Jack was given no special treatment in the tournament.

While you are not looking forward to the poker tournament ending and Deadwood returning to its slower-paced lifestyle, you are excited to attend the Deadwood Poker Tournament Party. With the grand prize of $100,000 being awarded, there is certain to be a lot of action at the cantina!

Acting and Dressing Your Part: As a resident of Deadwood, a small frontier town in the Wild West, you are a rough and rugged cowboy or cowgirl. To the party, you will want to wear your western best, which may consist of cowboy boots, a hat, a bandana, shoestring tie, spurs, fringe, chaps and any other accessory you desire. *For more ideas on how to dress and a glossary of wild western words and phrases to use at the party, please see the party tips at www.nightofmystery.com. Simply type in murderatthedeadwoodcantina.com and explore the Guest Info and Costuming sections.*



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